

Chapter One

HERMA SANS REGULAR

The history of every company is characterised by a few outstanding personalities. The history of HERMA covers the exciting story of this family-owned company.

It starts in 1906 with the founder *Heinrich Hermann* and his family, describing his motivation to manufacture labels and his many *innovative ideas for self-adhesive products*.

Accelerated Growth

HERMA SANS BOLD

Strong growth in the adhesive materials business boosted the sales of HERMA GmbH in fiscal 2004. The Stuttgart-based global expert in self-adhesive technology pushed up its revenues by 7.4 % to a new record of 165.5 million euros (previous year 154.0 million euros). Sales advanced appreciably both at home (5.1 %) and abroad (10.3 %). The export ratio rose from 44.6 % in 2003 to 45.8 %. The 2004 result came under strain, as anticipated, and declined from 3.0 million euros to 1.3 million euros. Above all, it was impaired by the steep increase in depreciation triggered by record investments in each of the two preceding years, including in the new logistics centre (total investment about 15 million euros). Sales of the HERMA Group, which has subsidiaries in France, Great Britain, Austria and the Netherlands, climbed 9.0 % to 174.8 million euros.

Anyone

HERMA SANS BLACK

who can develop an idea to perfection from its beginnings earns some respect.

This is why HERMA is recognised as one of the leading specialists in self-adhesive technology beyond the borders of Europe. With a comprehensive range of know-how – from the manufacture of adhesive materials, self-adhesive products and labelling solutions, right up to labelling machines. We usually call someone professional when they are master of their field and develop with human values. We warmly invite you to discover our world with its three independent divisions and participate in some innovative ideas

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